



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Peter and Amy may be facing a problem: incompatibility



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How would you describe your personality?
- What do you do to get along with people who have different personalities than yours?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a comparison and contrast paragraph.
- I can write about beliefs, opinions, relationships or character traits.
- I can express concession, contrast or comparison.





Let's Explore!

Amy and Peter differ in a number of areas: * relationships, outlook on life, and employment.

* You can use a colon to introduce a series of items.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Amy and Peter are different in almost every aspect of their life. Firstly, their approaches to relationships are quite distinct. Rational and level-headed, Amy deals with situations in a logical manner. She is not caught up in needless emotional mind games or requires validation from her partner. She doesn't dwell on past mistakes and is prepared to speak her mind when she feels she is not being heard. In comparison, Peter's sensitive nature can leave him feeling apprehensive to change and insecure in his relationships. This internal anxiety can manifest itself as inappropriate behavior and a lack of self-esteem. He can appear thoughtless and controlling. Often, he can dwell on situations that are completely inconsequential.

Another way this couple differ is their mindset towards life. Amy is optimistic about the future. She is ready to embrace life and tackle any challenges with positive energy and enthusiasm. Conversely, Peter's pessimistic outlook overrides most situations. He tends to prescribe to the glass half empty philosophy, as a way to protect himself and to handle any possible negative outcome. Finally, how they approach their jobs reflects their personalities. Amy's job as a life coach encourages others to reach their personal goals. She focuses on establishing balanced lifestyles and inner confidence. Her gregarious, uplifting spirit coupled with her dislike for excuses and negative self talk, is a breath of fresh air to her overwhelmed clients.

Furthermore, Amy has her own goals and is highly motivated to succeed. On the other hand, Peter is happily unemployed. He rarely felt the need to overextend himself in a work environment. In fact, the times he was prepared to work longer hours were based on an assumption that he would be rewarded monetarily or through promotions. Furthermore, he enjoyed negotiating his own position; however, he was often silenced by management. He was unable to handle constructive criticism, yet was quick to point out the flaws of others. Overall, these two lovebirds are polar opposites and will need to make some serious decisions in the future.





Let's Practice!

Amy and Peter differ in a number of areas: relationships, outlook on life, and employment.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. _____, their approaches to relationships are quite distinct.
2. _____, he was unable to handle constructive criticism yet was quick to point out the flaws of others.
3. _____, Peter is happily unemployed.
4. _____, Peter's pessimistic outlook overrides most situations. He tends to prescribe to the glass half empty philosophy, as a way to protect himself and to handle any possible negative outcome.
5. _____, he enjoyed negotiating his own position; however, he was often silenced by management.
6. _____, Peter's sensitive nature can leave him feeling apprehensive to change and insecure in his relationships.
7. _____ this couple differs is their mindset towards life.

COLUMN B

- a. Conversely
- b. Firstly
- c. Another way
- d. Then
- e. Furthermore
- f. In comparison
- g. On the other hand





Let's Practice!

These two are polar opposites.*

*"Polar opposites" means completely different.

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences

1) _____
and level-headed, Amy deals with
situations in a logical manner. She is
ready to 2) _____ life
and tackle any challenges with positive
energy and enthusiasm. Her gregarious,
uplifting spirit coupled with her dislike for
excuses and negative 3) _____ ,
is a 4) _____ to her
overwhelmed clients. Peter's internal
5) _____ can manifest
itself as 6) _____
behavior and a lack of self-esteem. He
can appear thoughtless and
7) _____. He tends to
prescribe to the glass half
8) _____ philosophy,
as a way to 9) _____ himself and
to handle any possible negative outcome.
He was unable to handle constructive
10) _____ yet was quick to
point out the 11) _____
of others. Overall, these two
12) _____ are polar opposites
and will need to make some serious
decisions in the future.

Word Bank

Criticism / controlling / protect 7
inappropriate / anxiety / lovebirds /
embrace / self talk / flaws / empty /
breath of fresh air / Rational





Extension Activity

Are you able to compare different behaviors and viewpoints?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 180-200 word compare and contrast paragraph about the differences between a good boss and a bad boss.
- Start with a topic sentences that identifies what you are writing about.
- Compare three key points and then add supporting information to each.
- Complete the paragraph by adding a sentence that reinforces the main idea.
- Use linking words to contrast ideas and link sentences.
- When complete, read your paragraph to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a compare and contrast paragraph about behaviors and attributes.

☐ ☐

I use linking words to contrast ideas and link sentences.

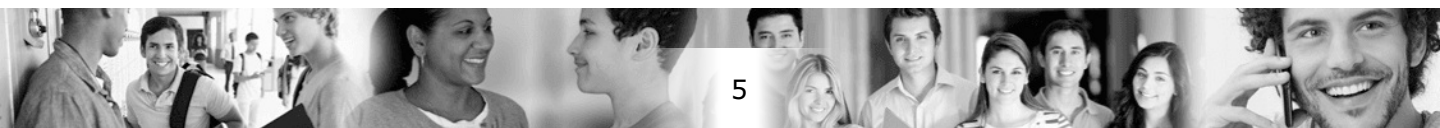
☐ ☐

I read my paragraph about comparison and contrast aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- mind game** (expression): a series of deliberate actions or responses planned for psychological effect on another
e.g. She is not caught up in needless emotional mind games.
- to embrace** (verb): to use an opportunity eagerly
e.g. She is ready to embrace life and tackle any challenges with positive energy and enthusiasm.
- self talk** (noun): Information that someone says to oneself
e.g. Amy does not like negative self talk.
- flaw** (noun): a small fault or weakness
e.g. He was unable to handle constructive criticism yet was quick to point out the flaws of others.
- lovebirds** (expression): two people in love
e.g. Overall, these two lovebirds are polar opposites and will need to make some serious decisions in the future.
- breath of fresh air** (expression): something positive and new
e.g. Her gregarious, uplifting spirit coupled with her dislike for excuses and negative self talk, is a breath of fresh air to her overwhelmed clients.
- monetarily** (adverb): of or relating to money
e.g. In fact, the times he was prepared to work longer hours were based on an assumption that he would be rewarded monetarily or through promotion.
- validation** (noun): to show that someone's feelings, opinions are fair and reasonable
e.g. She doesn't require validation from her partner.
- to manifest** (verb): clearly shown or visible
e.g. This internal anxiety can manifest itself as inappropriate behavior and a lack of self-esteem.





Learning Points

Comparison and Contrast Paragraph

Comparison shows similarities between persons, places, things, ideas, or situations. On the other hand, contrast points out the differences between persons, places, things, ideas, or situations.

When writing a comparison and contrast paragraph, your topic sentence should identify both subjects to be compared or contrasted. It should also tell the reader exactly what you are going to say about these items. Then, include three key points of difference or similarity in the body of your paragraph. Each point should provide examples that demonstrate similarities or differences. The concluding sentence reinforces the controlling idea (main idea).

Here are linking words that express comparison or contrast in these types of paragraphs.

See the chart below.

Comparison	Example	Contrast	Example
In the same way,	In the same way, Lisa prefers outdoor activities.	Whereas,	Whereas, Robert likes to watch movies in the evenings, Julie prefers to take the dog for a walk.
Like ... , ... [verb] ...	Like Julie, Stephanie likes to spend as much time outside as possible.	In contrast,	In contrast, Robert and his friends play videos games most weekends.
Another way in which ... is	Another way in which they are similar is their interest in different art forms.	On the other hand,	On the other hand, they have different opinions when it comes to art forms.
Similar to ... is (that) ...	Similar to Louise, Jennifer's personality is like a breath of fresh air.	Conversely,	Conversely, Steve is often grumpy at work.

Examples:

- *Another way this couple differ is their mindset towards life.*
- *Conversely, Peter's pessimistic outlook overrides most situations.*
- *On the other hand, Peter is happily unemployed.*
- *Furthermore, he enjoyed negotiating his own position; however, he was often silenced by management.*





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Linking Words that Express Concession/Contrast

You can use a variety of words and phrases to link your ideas and add coherence within a paragraph. When you want to write about a concession (a contrast between a predicted action and a circumstance) you can use conjunctions, adverbs or prepositions to link your ideas.

Conjunctions: A conjunction is a connecting word. *although* = *though* / *even though* = *even if*

For example:

*I was happy to watch the movies **even though** I had seen it with some friends the previous week.*

You can use these at the beginning of the clauses they introduce.

For example:

Although *Amy and Peter are a couple, there will be some challenges for them in the future.*
When you use *however* at the beginning of a sentence, you need to use a comma after it.

You can place **though** at the end of the sentence.

For example:

*They are not together now. They love each other **though**.*

Adverbs: Adverbs are verbs that describe or modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs.

For example:

Verb: *The building was built gradually.* (In this case, the adverb "gradually" describes the verb "built".)

Adjective: *The building has very large stones.* (In this case, the adverb "very" modifies the adjective "large".)

Adverb: *The architect is almost always right.* (In this case, the adverb "almost" modifies the adverb "always".)

For example:

*They haven't met him **yet**.*

*He was determined, **nevertheless**, to ensure the night was a great success.*

*She was to attend; **however**, her flight was late.*

Prepositions: A preposition is a word or group of words that indicates location or relationship between a noun or pronoun and other parts of the sentence. These are followed by a noun or a gerund. *across* = *beside* = *between* = *through*

For example:

*Once I knew I was on the right career path, I was prepared to move **across** the country.*





Learning Points

*I would never want to get in **between** the two of you.
Everyone needs to jump **through** hoops during their career.*

Examples:

- *Furthermore, he enjoyed negotiating his own position; however, he was often silenced by management.*
- *He was unable to handle constructive criticism, yet was quick to point out the flaws of others.*

